

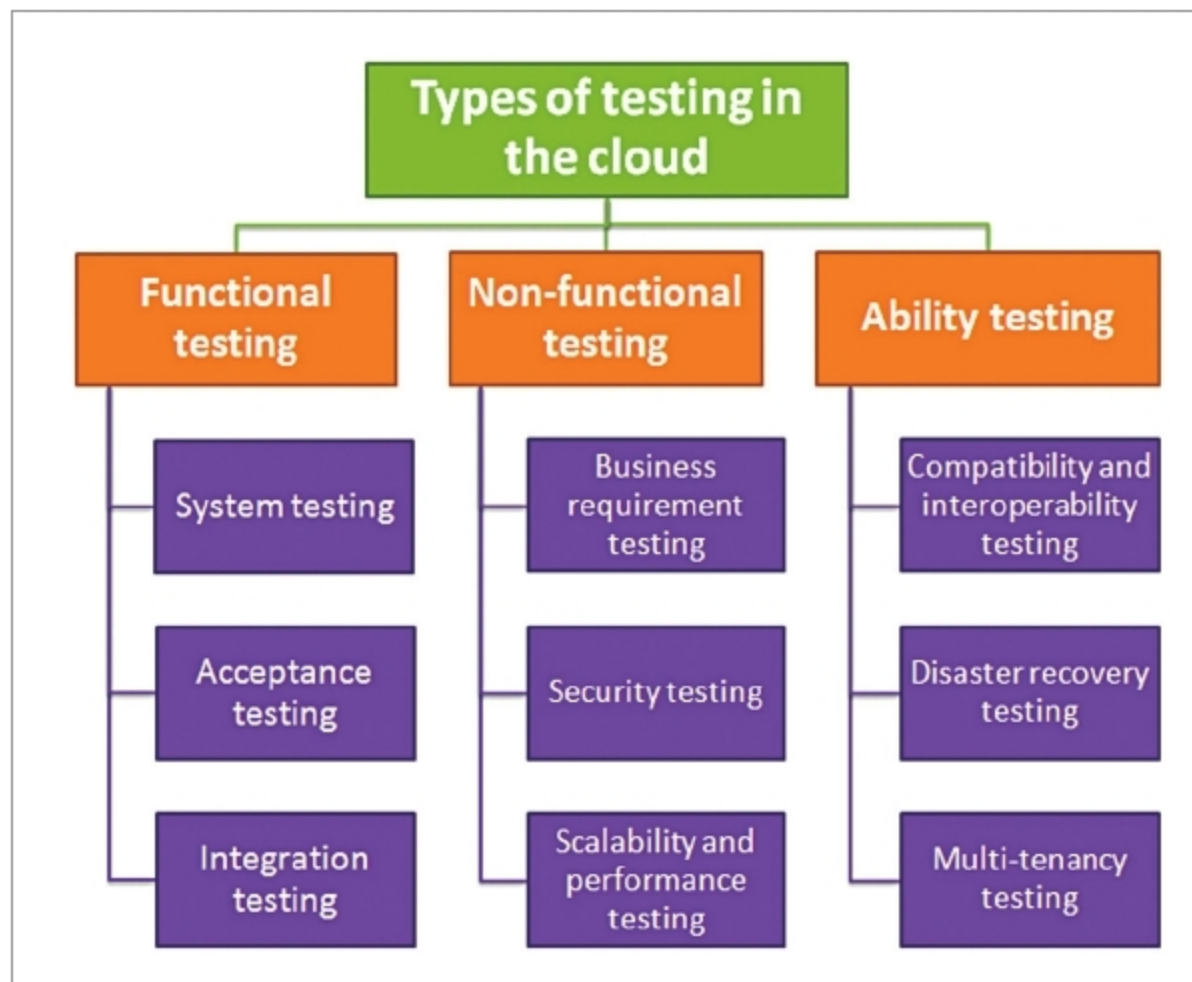


Figure 2: Types of testing in the cloud (Credit: www.apriorit.com)

Security in the cloud still raises many concerns, as encryption techniques are far from perfect. There are still concerns about security of data that may be stored in a remote location beyond a company's legal jurisdiction. While providers guarantee round-the-clock availability of their services, even the least bit of downtime can cause negative consequences to testing processes.

Before selecting cloud-based testing tools, it is necessary to make sure the provider offers all configurations, storage and technologies that are needed, as it may be difficult to emulate customer environments if some configurations are not supported by the provider. Moreover, creating

a test environment that includes all necessary settings and data can be time-consuming for testers.

Although vendors inform their clients about prices for their cloud-based services, improper use of test environments may significantly increase costs. To avoid hidden costs, testers should thoroughly plan their test environments to take into account additional costs such as for data encryption and monitoring the use of cloud resources.

Future of cloud technology in measurement

Cloud-based testing offers Web-based access to real devices spread globally and connected through live networks,

providing end-to-end control for manual and automated testing practices. For teams spread across different locations, cloud-based test management platforms make collaboration possible. Users can log in from anywhere in the world, at any time, on any device and get access to the test environment.

Cloud-based tools provide real-time report generation and upgradation. This makes it infinitely easier to share and track important data, and communicate with each other. A tester in any company office can connect to the cloud and select the machine he or she wants to test an application on. Every time the tester adds a piece of code, tests it and then redeploys it, the app immediately moves to production and release. This allows all members of the project team to collaborate in real time on a test so that problems can be identified and resolved rapidly.

Cloud-based tools have 24/7 support, and users should seek a contract where they are compensated for any downtime. Cloud-based tools reduce IT management tasks like installation, adding or replacing users, licensing and upgrades in systems across geographies. Users have a simple browser log-in that is accessible on any device, and they should be able to add or remove licences whenever they need to. Cloud-based test management tools are flexible and agile-friendly. **END** 

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